

ALOE

**A. ferox** (illus. p.493). Evergreen, treelike succulent. H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 5ft (1.5m). Has a woody stem crowned by a dense rosette of sword-shaped, blue-green leaves that have spined margins. Produces an erect spike of bell-shaped, orange-scarlet flowers in spring. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. haworthioides** (illus. p.493). Stemless succulent suckering to form clumps. H 2½in (6cm), S 4in (10cm). Has dense rosettes of lance-shaped, dark green leaves, suffused red in dry conditions, with many raised, white bristles and margins with small, white teeth set close together. Unbranched flower stems, 8–12in (15–30cm) long, bear bell-shaped, white to pale pink flowers, 3in (8cm) long, in summer. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. hemmingii** (illus. p.493). Basal rosetted, perennial succulent. H 6in (15cm), S 10in (25cm). Has a rosette of ovate to lance-shaped, olive green leaves, 4in (10cm) long, with dull, white streaks and short, sharp teeth at the margins. Produces unbranched flower stems, 12in (30cm) long, with tubular, minutely spotted, flamingo-pink to pale rose flowers, 1in (25cm) long, in summer. Z11 (min. 54°F/12°C)

**A. humilis**. Rosetted succulent. H 4in (10cm), S 12in (30cm). Has a dense, basal rosette of narrowly sword-shaped, spine-edged, fleshy, blue-green leaves, often erect, with incurving tips. Produces flower stems 12in (30cm) long, each bearing a spike of narrowly bell-shaped, orange flowers in spring 1½–1¾in (3.5–4.5cm) long. Offsets freely. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. melanacantha var. erinacea**, syn. *A. erinacea*. Slow-growing, clump-forming succulent. H 6in (15cm), S 12in (30cm). Compact rosettes of triangular to lance-shaped, dull-green leaves have sharp, black spines at the margins and a black spine at each tip. Unbranched flower stems, to 3ft (1m) long, produce dense, cylindrical clusters of bell-shaped, scarlet flowers, 1¼in (3cm) long, fading to yellow, in summer. Z10–11

**A. microstigma**. Basal-rosetted succulent. H 12in (30cm), S 10–24in (25–60cm). Lance-shaped to triangular, red-tinged, mid-green leaves, often white spotted, especially beneath, have reddish-brown margins with small, reddish-brown teeth. Unbranched flower stems, 2ft (60cm) long, bear conical racemes of bell-shaped, orange flowers, 10in (25cm) long, fading to greenish-yellow, in summer. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. mitriformis**. See *A. perfoliata*.

**A. perfoliata**, syn. *A. mitriformis*, *A. xanthacantha*. Variable, clump-forming succulent. H to 6ft (2m), S indefinite. Thick, nearly erect or horizontal stems bear terminal rosettes of ovate-lance-shaped, fleshy, bluish-green leaves, 18in (45cm) long, keeled beneath, suffused red in poor soils. Keel and leaf margins are yellow-toothed. Produces broadly conical, occasionally branched, axillary racemes, 16–24in (40–60cm) long, of tubular, dull scarlet flowers, 1½–2in (4–5cm) long, on branched stems in winter. Z9–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. plicatilis**. See *Kumara plicatilis*.

**A. rauhii**. Basal-rosetted succulent eventually forming dense clumps. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S indefinite. Unbranched stems,

to 10in (25cm) long, of tubular, scarlet flowers, 1in (25cm) long, pale red to greenish toward mouths, are borne throughout the year. Lance-shaped, grayish or bright green leaves have many elongated, white spots and small, white teeth at the margins. In some forms, the leaves have raised dots or are almost white with green dots. Z11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. somaliensis**. Basal-rosetted succulent. H 12in (30cm), S 10in (25cm). Lance-shaped, glossy olive-green leaves, 8–16in (20–40cm) long, with dull, white streaks, have short, sharp teeth at the margins. Branched flower stems, 1–2ft (30–60cm) long, with tubular, minutely spotted, flamingo-pink to pale rose flowers, 1in (25cm) long, are borne in summer. Z11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. squarrosa**, syn. *A. concinna*. Prostrate succulent. H 12in (30cm), S 8in (20cm). Has lance-shaped, strongly recurved, toothed, white-speckled, mid-green leaves borne along short stems. Unbranched, pendulous flower stems, 4–10in (10–25cm) long, of tubular, red flowers, 1in (25cm) long, are produced in summer. Z11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. striata** (illus. p.493). Basal-rosetted succulent. H 3ft (1m), S 34in (85cm). Has broad, blue-green leaves, with white margins and marks, that become suffused red in full sun. Produces reddish-orange flowers in spring. Good as a houseplant. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

**A. vera**, syn. *A. barbadensis*, illus. p.492.

**A. xanthacantha**. See *A. perfoliata*.

**A. zebrina**. Basal-rosetted succulent. H 12in (30cm), S 32in (80cm). Lance-shaped, dull green leaves, with white chevrons, have sharp, brown teeth at the margins. Branched flower stems, 3ft (1m) long, of tubular, coral-red to dull red flowers, 1¼in (3cm) long, are produced in summer. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

ALOIAMPELOS

ASPHODELACEAE

Genus of evergreen succulent perennial shrubs with sprawling or scrambling stems. Narrow, toothed leaves are arranged in spirals along the stems and racemes of small, narrow, cylindrical to tubular flowers are borne in summer. Requires a sunny site and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed, stem cuttings or by offsets in spring or summer.

**A. ciliaris**, syn. *Aloe ciliaris*. Climbing, perennial succulent. H 15ft (5m), S 1ft (30cm). Has a slender stem crowned by a rosette of narrow, green leaves and white teeth where leaf base joins stem. Bears bell-shaped, scarlet flowers, with yellow and green mouths, in spring. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

ALOINOPSIS

AIZOACEAE

Genus of dwarf, tuberous, perennial succulents, bearing daisylike flowers from late summer to early spring. Needs a sunny site and very well-drained soil; in warm, dry areas grow in a raised bed or border. Very susceptible to overwatering. Mealy bugs may be a problem. Propagate by seed in summer.

**A. schooneesii** illus. p.488.

ALONSOA

SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, subshrubs and perennials. May be used for cut flowers. Grow in sun and in rich, well-drained soil. Flowering may be poor outdoors in a wet summer. Pinch out growing shoots of young plants to promote bushy growth. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in late spring. Aphids may be troublesome, particularly under glass.

**A. warscewiczii** (Mask flower) illus. p.308.

ALOPECURUS

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES and SEDGES.

**A. pratensis ‘Aureovariegatus’**, syn. *A.p. ‘Aureomarginatus’* (Golden foxtail), illus. p.289.

ALOYSIA

VERBENACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen, summer-flowering shrubs, grown for their aromatic foliage and sprays of tiny flowers. Where marginally hardy, plant against a south- or west-facing wall or raise afresh each year. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Cut out any dead wood in early summer. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

**A. triphylla**, syn. *Lippia citriodora* (Lemon verbena), illus. p.132.

ALPINIA

ZINGIBERACEAE

Genus of rhizomatous, evergreen, perennials with fleshy rhizomes, grown for their flowers. Needs well-drained soil with plenty of humus, partial shade and a moist atmosphere. Not easy to grow successfully in containers. Propagate by division in late spring or early summer. Red spider mite may be a problem.

**A. calcarata** (Indian ginger). Evergreen, upright, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1–2ft (30–60cm). Has stalkless, aromatic, lance-shaped leaves, to 1ft (30cm) long. At any time of year may bear horizontal spikes of whitish flowers, with 1in (25cm) long, yellow lips marked reddish-purple. Z14–15 (min. 61°F/16°C)

**A. japonica**. Clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 12in (30cm). Biennial stems arising from the rhizome, bear lance-shaped leaves, to 16in (40cm) long, hairy on the underside. From spring to summer, bears white flowers with red stripes in racemes, 6–12in (15–30cm) long, at the apex of the previous year’s stems, followed by ovoid red capsules. Aerial stems may withstand light frost, but need protection during most winters if they are to bear flowers. Z8–11

**A. nutans** of gardens. See *A. zerumbet*.

**A. purpurata** (Cone ginger; illus. p.477). Vigorous, evergreen, upright perennial. H 10–12ft (3–4m), S 2–3ft (60–90cm). In summer, produces conelike spires, 14in (35cm) long, of many small, white flowers, to 1in (25cm) long, in the axils of persistent, red or pink bracts. Has stalked,

oblong, hairless, mid-green leaves, to 3ft (90cm) long. Good for cut flowers. Z11 (min. 61°F/16°C)

**A. speciosa**. See *A. zerumbet*.

**A. zerumbet**, syn. *A. nutans* of gardens, *A. speciosa* (Shell flower, Shell ginger; illus. p.477). Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 10ft (3m), S 3–4ft (1–1.2m). Has racemes of white flowers, with yellow lips and pink- or red-marked throats, mainly in summer. Z12 (min. 45°F/7°C)

**Alsobia**. See *Episcia*.

**Alsophila**. See *Cyathea*.

ALSTROEMERIA

ALSTROEMERIACEAE

Genus of mostly summer- to fall-flowering, tuberous perennials with showy, funnel-shaped, multicolored flowers. Flowers are good for cutting as they last well. Produces erect stems with alternate or scattered, linear to lance-shaped, mid- to gray-green leaves, usually 3–5in (7–12cm) long, held on twisted leaf stalks. Where marginally hardy, protect dormant tubers with a dry mulch. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or division in early spring. ☉ Contact with foliage may aggravate skin allergies.

**‘Apollo’** (illus. p.387). Midsummer to fall-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 5ft (1.5m). Bears large, open, white flowers with brown markings and yellow throats. Z7–10.

**A. aurantiaca**. See *A. aurea*.

**A. aurea**, syn. *A. aurantiaca*. Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 18in (45cm). Produces orange flowers, tipped with green and streaked dark red. Z7–10. **‘Orange King’** (illus. p.387) bears bright orange flowers, with brown-speckled throats, from midsummer to fall.

**A. ‘Blushing Bride’** (illus. p.387). Midsummer- to fall-flowering, tuberous perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm). Produces cream flowers with brown-speckled, pink and pale yellow throats. Z7–10

**A. ‘Cahors’**. Midsummer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 28in (70cm), S 2ft (60cm). Produces rich pink flowers with dark red-flecked, yellow throats. Z7–10

**A. ‘Charm’**. Midsummer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 2½ft (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has pale peach flowers with brown speckles and primrose-yellow throats. Z7–10

**A. ‘Elvira’** (illus. p.387). Midsummer- to fall-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 2½ft (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Produces cream flowers with bold, pink flecks on outer edges of petals and at the throats. Z7–10

**A. ‘Friendship’** (illus. p.387). Midsummer- to fall-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 20in (50cm). Produces pale lime-yellow flowers with brown-red speckled, yellow throats. Z7–10.

**A. hookeri** illus. p.361.

**A. Inca Ice ‘Koice’** (illus. p.387). Late-spring- to fall-flowering, tuberous perennial. H and S to 3ft (1m). Produces cream and pale yellow flowers with pink throats and purple-brown speckling on the upper and lower petals. Z7–10

**A. Inca Tropic ‘Kotrop’** (illus. p.387). Midsummer- to fall-flowering, tuberous